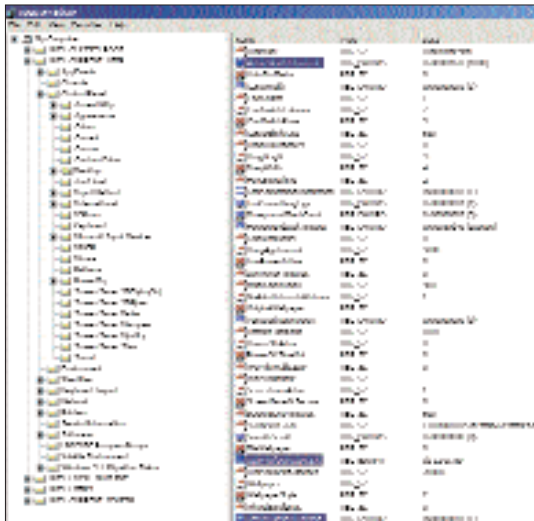




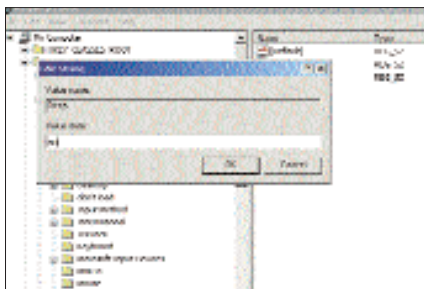
Enabling Active Window Tracking

tricky. What we need to do is add Hexadecimal 41 to the first Hexadecimal number in the value. For example, the "UserPreferencesMask" value in our test PC had the value "90 12 01 80". Start Calculator and select **View > Scientific**. Select the Hex radio button in the top row and add 41 to the first two numbers (in our case, 90 + 41, which gave us a result of D1). Now edit the "UserPreferencesMask" value data and replace the first two digits with the result you just got (ours now reads D1 12 05 80).

The next step is to create a new DWORD called "ActiveWindow Tracking" (if it isn't already there) and set its value data to 1. Next, create (or edit) the "ActiveWndTrkTimeout" DWORD. When entering its value data, choose Decimal and type in how many milliseconds you want to wait before switching windows. Now restart Windows and *voilà!*

### End The Beeping

Do random Windows events cause your PC speaker to beep in that annoying manner? Shut it up permanently. Navigate to **HKEY\_CURRENT\_USER\Control Panel\Sound** and double-click the "Beep" value. Change the value data to "No", and you won't hear a peep...er...beep again.



Joining an existing network

### Enable Your Network Adaptor's Onboard Processor

If your network card has an onboard processor (you can find this out from the vendor's Web site), it can take off the load of network processing from your CPU. Navigate to **HKEY\_LOCAL\_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\Tcpip\Parameters** and create a new DWORD called "DisableTaskOffload". Set its value to 0 to enable offloading network processing onto the network card. Restart Windows for this to take effect.

### Change Outlook XP's Restricted Files

Outlook blocks attachments with the following extensions by default: ade, adp, asx, bas, bat, chm, cmd, com, cpl, crt, exe, hlp, hta, inf, ins, isp, js, jse, lnk, mda, mdb, mde, mdz, msc, msi, msp, mst, pcd, pif, prf, reg, scf, scr, sct, shb, shs, url, vb, vbe, vbs, wsc, wsf and wsh

However, if you want to allow any of the above file types, navigate to **HKEY\_CURRENT\_USER\Software\Microsoft\Office\10.0\Outlook\Security** and create a new string value called "Level1Remove". In the value data, enter the extensions that you want to allow, separated by a semicolon. For example, "exe;bat;pif" and so on. Do remember that these file types are often used to spread malicious code, so be careful when using this trick.

### Optimise Your Hard Disk When Your PC Is Idle

This tweak will make Windows rearrange data on your hard disk when the PC is idle, so that applications will run faster. Navigate to **HKEY\_LOCAL\_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\MicrosoftLayout** and create a new DWORD called EnableAutoLayout (if it isn't already there). Set the value data to 1 and restart your PC. When you leave your PC idle now, Windows will optimise your hard disk.

### Copy NTFS Permissions

If you copy files from one NTFS drive to another, it loses its permissions, inheriting the default permissions of the new drive. To make Windows preserve the current permissions, navigate to **HKEY\_CURRENT\_USER\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer** and create a new DWORD called "ForceCopyAclwithFile". Set the

value to 1 to preserve the original permissions.

### Set Disk Defragmenter Options

The Windows XP disk defragmenter doesn't really allow you much in the way of customising the defragmentation. To set a defragmentation method, navigate to **HKEY\_CURRENT\_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Applications\Defrag\Settings** and create a new key called Method under Settings. In the Method key, edit the (Default) string and set it to any of these options: **FULL** - Defragment files, space and optimise programs. **FULLNOAPPLOG** - Defragment files and space.

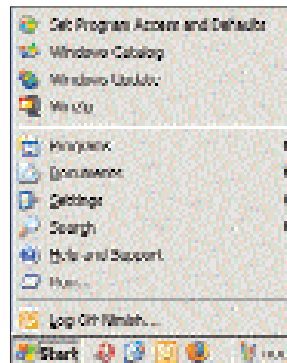
**FILES** - Defragment files only.

**SPACE** - Defragment space only.

To decide whether to run scandisk before starting the defragmenter, create a key called "scandisk" under Settings and set "(Default)" to TRUE or FALSE.

### Disable Shut Down

If you don't want anyone to shut down your PC, you can disable the command altogether. Navigate to



Where did Shut Down go?

**HKEY\_CURRENT\_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer**. In the right-hand pane, right-click and select **New > DWORD Value** and call it "NoClose". Set its value to 1 to disable shutting down the PC.

### Re-initialise the registry without rebooting

If you don't want to restart or log off to make a registry tweak work, try this instead:

Use **[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [Esc]** to bring up the Task Manager. Under the Processes tab, select "explorer.exe" and click on End Task. Note: This will kill any Explorer windows you have open. Explorer.exe will restart automatically because Windows can't run without it, and your new registry settings will now be loaded. ■